

EDM 101 – Ethics and Patients' Rights in Dental Medicine

Lecture 9

Informed Consent

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This classes learning outcomes

By the end of this lecture you are able to

- Explain the concept and components of informed consent.
- Identify different types of consent and decision-making situations.
- Understand how justice influences access to dental care and resource distribution.



An Informed Consent;

Informed consent:

- A process of communication
- Between dentist and patient
- That allows the patient to make a decision

It is:

- Is a legal requirement
- Is an ethical duty
- Is part of patient autonomy



Why is it important?

- A. It respects patient autonomy
- B. It builds trust
- C. It protects dentist legally
- D. It improves decision-making



What Should be Explained?

- A. Diagnosis
- B. Treatment options (including no treatment)
- C. Risks and benefits
- D. Costs
- E. Alternatives



The Components of a Valid Consent;

- A. Information – sufficient explanation should be provided
- B. Capacity – the patient can decide on their treatment
- C. Voluntary – no pressure should be applied on the patient



Types of Consent;

- A. Verbal consent
- B. Written consent
- C. Implied consent
- D. Explicit consent
- E. Presumed consent



Verbal and Written Consent

Verbal: simple, low-risk procedures.

Written: surgical or high-risk procedures.



Implied vs Explicit Consent

Implied: patient behavior (sitting in a chair).

Explicit: direct agreement for a treatment.



Presumed Consent (Emergencies)

Patient is unconscious

Immediate treatment is needed



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Consent in Children & Incompetent Patients

Decisions made by parents

Replacement (someone else) may decide for adults

Emergency which leads to presumed consent



Substitute Decision Making

It can be done in two ways;

- A. Substituted judgment, which is what the patient would want
- B. Best interest, which is what is best for the patient



Social Justice in Dentistry

- Fair distribution of healthcare
- Equal respect for all patients
- Access to care



Basic Needs and the Distribution of Care for Patients;

We should consider;

- A. Urgency
- B. Need
- C. Fairness



Contribution and Effort

Some systems consider:

- Patient's role in their healthcare and hygiene practices.

The main ethical concern is:

- May be unfair or discriminatory to judge their habits.



Free Market View

Healthcare based on:

- Ability to pay

Problem:

- Inequality in access

Healthcare being used as a business may conflict with justice.



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Basic Dental Care Concept

Everyone should be able to have:

- A. Emergency care
- B. Pain relief
- C. Basic treatment

Which is the minimum ethical standard.



Ethical thinking:

Dentists must control:

- A. Individual patient needs
- B. Limited resources
- C. Fairness



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Summary:

- Informed consent is communication and understanding
- Valid consent requires 3 elements
- Different types of consent exist
- Justice ensures fairness in care



Thank You!



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